population of 27 million, might become another area of militancy were: (1) It had the largest number of Deobandi *madaris.* (2) Dera Ghazi Khan district bordered with KP, Balochistan and Sindh therefore the nearest route of escape for fleeing fighters of TTP. (3). A considerable number of Lal masjid students and even the Ghazi brothers (one dead and other surviving) belonged to D.G. Khan. (4) Writ of government was weak as policing was placid in these areas. (5) Intelligence set-ups were inefficient; therefore, 'there was no proper surveillance over these elements'.

Since 2010, TTP and groups affiliated with it had been braving the army operation. Despite setbacks in Malakand and some tribal areas, they were still flourishing in the vast north-west regions of the country. They were carrying out terrorist acts with full vigour. On 24 August 2010, they carried out a suicide attack inside a mosque in Wana during Ramadan. A teenage boy blew himself up as he approached the seminary leader. At least 25 people were killed in this incident (*Dawn*, 2010). After two years, in 2012, the month of Ramadan (fasting) started with separate attacks launched by militants across the country, in which at least 20 people, including six children, were killed (see https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Terrorist_incidents_in_Pakistan_in_2012).

The security situation in insurgency-hit Balochistan became bad to worse as the fleeing TTP fighters regrouped there to carry out their terrorists activities. When stakes were high and going was tough, opposing forces at times joined hands against common adversary. In this case, both Baloch separatists and TTP militants were fighting against the state. The fallouts of the undesirable army action by General Musharraf against Nawab Bugti and other Balochi dissidents, the alleged Indian support to Balochi insurgents and Western claims of the presence of Mullah Omar and Afghan Taliban leadership in Quetta had made Balochistan a region of unrest and uncertainty. Even terrorists challenging the Iranian government set up bases in Balochistan (*Dawn*, 2008).

The metropolis Karachi, the home of the terrorist ethnic party, MQM, had been a troubled spot as various armed groups keep resorting to violence. During the first six months of 2009, approximately 100 persons, belonging to different groups, were killed in various incidents (*The Nation*, 2009). TTP had been taking advantage of these situations and committed robberies and kidnappings to raise funds for the resistance. The CID held financiers of TTP from Mauripur and youngsters from Karachi, belonging to proscribed militant organisations